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The short answer is that **Claude Code is a commercial, proprietary product that was accidentally leaked by Anthropic, not officially open-sourced.**  MindStudio

The headlines saying "Claude Code is open source" are using the term loosely to describe the community-driven fallout of the leak, or are referring to independent, open-source lookalikes built by the developer community.  YouTube · Josh Pocock +2

The timeline and mechanical reality of these two truths can be broke down as follows:

1. The Reality: The Source Code Leaked

On **March 31, 2026**, Anthropic accidentally published the entire unobfuscated TypeScript source code for Claude Code.  Zscaler

- **How it happened:** A developer forgot to add `*.map` to their `.npmignore` file during a public npm package release. Because the Bun build tool generates source maps by default, it inadvertently bundled a map file that linked directly to a 60MB ZIP archive containing over 512,000 lines of original TypeScript code on Anthropic's private servers.  Zscaler +2
- **What was exposed:** The "secret sauce" of how Claude acts as an agent (its multi-agent coordinator loops, token management, system prompts, parallel tool-calling architecture, and even a hidden Tamagotchi-like pet called `/buddy`).  Reddit · r/ClaudeAI +2
- **What was NOT exposed:** The proprietary **AI model weights** (the actual brain of Claude) or any user data.  YouTube · NeetCode +1

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from TypeScript into clean-room Python and Rust frameworks. These community-driven projects (like [OpenCode](#) or community GitHub replicas) effectively made the *architecture* open source and usable with alternative LLMs. [Reddit · r/LocalLLaMA +4](#)

- **Sensationalized Media Headlines:** Content creators and tech journalists used hyperbole, writing headlines like *"Claude Code is Now Open Source... Thanks to a Leak!"* to grab attention, even though the official tool remains proprietary. [MindStudio +1](#)

Summary of the Two Truths

Aspect	The Leak ("Source Leaked")	The "Open Source" Narrative
Intent	Completely accidental human error.	Unofficial, community-driven exploitation of the leak.
Legal Status	Proprietary. Anthropic actively issues DMCA takedowns.	Community projects use clean-room rewrites to bypass legal issues.
What it means for you	The blueprint of Anthropic's agent architecture became public knowledge.	You can now download independent, free open-source clones that mimic Claude Code.

If you are looking to build agentic workflows or study how top-tier terminal agents handle memory and tool execution, digging into the community's **reverse-engineered frameworks** is highly educational. If you want to know more about how the leak happened or how the community bypassed the legal takedowns, let me know! [Reddit · r/LocalLLaMA +2](#)

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 OpenCode

Claude Code's source just leaked — I extracted its multi-agent ...

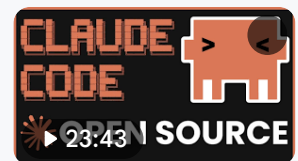
Mar 31, 2026 — Claude Code's source just leaked — I extracted its multi-agent orchestration system into an open-source framework that works with ...



 Reddit · r/LocalLLaMA

Claude Code Is Now Open Source... This Leak Changes ...

Apr 1, 2026 — this might be the biggest leak in AI history anthropic a \$60 billion. company accidentally shipped a source map in their MPM...



 YouTube · Josh Pocock

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please summarize the best clean room rewrites.

Following the March 31, 2026 leak, developers didn't just read the code; they immediately rebuilt the architecture from scratch to bypass Anthropic's DMCA takedown notices. Because clean-room rewrites capture the functional patterns in a different programming language without copying the literal proprietary text, they exist in a legally distinct gray area.  Reddit · r/LocalLLaMA +3

The most prominent, robust clean-room rewrites and open-source clones that emerged from the fallout include the following projects:

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into a dual **Rust and Python** framework. [claw-code.codes +1](#)

- **Key Focus:** It mirrors Claude Code's core terminal agent harness—specifically copying the multi-agent coordination loop, prompt context-compaction logic, and built-in developer tool modules. [claw-code.codes +1](#)

2. Claurst ([claurst](#))

Claurst is an open-source terminal coding agent built entirely from the ground up in **Rust** based on the leaked functional specifications. [GitHub](#)

- **The Improvement:** It turns the architecture into a true, high-performance terminal user interface (TUI) pair programmer.
- **Key Focus:** Unlike the original Claude Code, Claurst strips out all of Anthropic's tracking and telemetry. It also natively supports **multi-provider LLMs** (allowing you to use OpenAI or local models instead of just Claude) and includes an upgraded version of the memory consolidation system. [GitHub](#)

3. OpenClaude / Open-Claude-Code

Several community-led repositories grouped under the **OpenClaude** banner emerged immediately to provide clean-room, model-agnostic alternatives. [GitHub +1](#)

- **The Method:** Projects like [ruvnet/open-claude-code](#) utilized specific package analysis tools to extract intelligence from the accidental npm package and rebuild the CLI legally. [GitHub](#)
- **Key Focus:** These builds isolated Claude Code's **three-tier permission architecture** and ML safety classifier to give developers a secure, open-

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Gather, Consolidate, and Prune routine that keeps an agent's project context under 200 lines and 25KB to prevent context bloat. Level Up Coding

- **Model Agnosticism:** Rewriting the hardcoded Anthropic API layers into generic `LLMAdapter` interfaces so developers can route tasks to cheaper or local models. Reddit · r/ClaudeAI

⚠ Important Security Warning

If you are looking to download or explore these rewrites, stick **strictly** to the official main forks like [Claw Code](#) or verified GitHub projects. Security researchers caught malicious actors using the hype around the "Claude Code leak" to distribute fake GitHub repositories and malicious npm packages packed with **infostealer malware**. claw-code.codes +1

Would you like help setting up one of these open-source clones locally, or are you interested in knowing how they handle **local LLM routing**?

15 sites

Kuberwastaken/claurst: Agentic Coding for Builders who Ship

Claurst is an open-source, multi-provider terminal coding agent built from the ground up in Rust. It started as a clean-room reimp...

GitHub

Claw Code — Open-Source AI Coding Agent Framework ...

Claw Code is an open-source AI coding agent framework built in Rust and Python. It is a clean-room rewrite of the Claude Code agen...

claw-code.codes

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